

Ch2

1. Two ways to view world

- a. **Selfish** point of view: consider only your own self and your core values
- b. **Ethical** point of view: respect other people and their core values

2. Morality (道德)

- a. A society's rules of conduct 社会行为准则
- b. What people ought / ought not to do in various situations

3. Ethics (伦理)

- a. The philosophical study of morality
- b. Rational examination into people's moral beliefs and behavior
- c. Ethics focuses on people's voluntary, moral choices make.

d. Ethical analysis

- i. Ethics: rational, systematic 有条理的、系统的 analysis of conduct that can cause benefit or harm to other people
- ii. *If it is an ethical question, we do ethical analysis.*
- iii. Conclusions must be support.(people are required to explain why) based on facts/values, shared values, logic
- iv. When there are different conclusions:

■ Compare ethical evaluations by weighing the facts and the reasoning process behind their conclusions to determine the stronger line of thinking 通过权衡事实和结论背后的推理过程来比较道德评估, 以确定更有力的思路

伦理评估: 对某一行为、决策或政策的道德性进行分析和判断的过程。

4. Ethical relativism/objectivism

Ethical relativism

- Morality is a human **invention**/inside the human mind.
- Moral values are subjective and dependent on individual or cultural perspectives.
- Theory that there are no universal moral norms of right and wrong.

1. Subjective relativism

Each person decides right and wrong for himself or herself

2. Cultural relativism

What is "right" and "wrong" depends upon a society's actual moral guidelines

Ethical objectivism

Divine Command theory/ Ethical Egoism/Kantianism/Act Utilitarianism/Rule Utilitarianism/Social Contract Theory/Virtue Ethics

- Morality has an existence outside the human mind, Our role as humans is to discover "the good."
 - Asserting that there are **objective moral principles** that apply universally to all individuals, regardless of personal beliefs or cultural norms. –认为存在客观的道德原则，无论个人信仰或文化规范如何，都普遍适用于所有人
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5. Kantianism

Categorical Imperative–绝对命令

1st Formulation: **Act only from moral rules that you can at the same time will to be universal moral laws.**

Ans:

- ①概念–The 1st Formulation states...
- ②Goal? –文章中的主人公的行为目标
- ③Assume the rule that... (尽可能的紧贴题目中的行为，不要过于宏观)
- ④Imagine this rule is universalized,... (分析过程)
- ⑤Find the contradiction--xxx will not achieve the goal.
- ⑥Therefore, the action is morally wrong/right.

▼ sample Ans.

Using the first formulation "Categorical imperative", which states that one should act only according to that maxim which can be made a universal law. Assume the rule that "I can steal another person's login and use the computing facility when I am in need of them".

Imagine this rule is universalized, then everyone likes Alexis, when in need, steals someone's password and accesses the library's computer in an unauthorized way. In this case, the library may implement a stricter policy of security (say, 2-factor authentication, biometrics, etc.), then Alexis **will not achieve her goal. Therefore, the action is wrong!**

2nd Formulation: Act so that you treat both yourself and other people as ends in themselves and never only as a means to an end.

如何区分把人当作目的/手段? -- 当作目的会考虑人的感受的! / 在这种情况下不考虑人的感受也许会得到更高的利益, 但是我尊重你, 给你选择权 -- 我把你当作了目的而非手段。

其实, 人在case中是目的还是手段很模棱两可, 言之有理, 配合案例解释清楚观点即可

Ans:

①概念--The 2nd Formulation states...

② (找出means-B和end-xxx) A **treated** B as a means to A's end of xxx . A didn't treat B as a rational being.

③Therefore, the action is morally wrong/right.

▼ sample Ans.

Using the second formation, which states that treat both yourself and others as ends themselves, never only as means to an end. Alexis **treated** the student as a means to her end of getting access to the private college's computers. **Therefore, the action is wrong!**

Perfect/Imperfect Duties

- Perfect duty: duty obliged to fulfill without exception--必须履行 没有例外
- Imperfect duty: duty obliged to fulfill in general but not in every instance
- If there is a conflict between a perfect duty and an imperfect duty, the perfect duty must prevail 占上风.

Ans:

① (某行为) is a perfect duty ,which is absolute and must be fulfilled in all situations in Kantiansim.

②结合事例分析解释(示例中的哪些举动是这个行为?)

③【如有 optional】 (某行为) is a imperfect duty,which obliged to fulfill in general but not in every instance.

④【optional】 结合实例分析解释

⑤【optional】 If there is a conflict between a perfect duty and an imperfect duty, the perfect duty must prevail

⑥Therefore, the action is morally wrong/right.

▼ sample Ans.

“Not to steal” is a **perfect duty which is absolute and must be fulfilled in all situations in Kantianism**. Alexis stealing another person’s login information is also an act of stealing, which is not acceptable. **Therefore, the action is wrong!**

Good Will : The desire to do the right Things

- The company offers a discount for the beta software to mitigate potential loss of customer can be seen as good will.

6. Utilitarianism

- Based on the principle of utility : The moral action is the one the produces the **maximum** increase in happiness. / An action is deemed认为 right if it conforms 符合 to a rule that, when generally followed, leads to the greatest overall happiness or utility
 - Utility: tendency of an object to produce happiness or prevent unhappiness for an individual or a community
- **Focuses on the consequences:** A consequentialist theory
- The focus is on the outcomes of actions rather than intentions.
- Affected parties to be **expressed quantitatively**

a. Act Utilitarianism

(You need to list the **benefits** and **harms** to the **affected beings**, try to **quantify** the effects)

Maximizes the sum

Ans:

Benefits: ...

Harms: ...

比较哪个影响更大 xx exceed xx/...is a good/bad action

b. Rule Utilitarianism

Ans:

- ① Assume a rule: "..."
 - ② Imagine if the rule is followed by everyone,
 - ③ 分析谁受益/谁不受益。
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7. Social contract theory

规则在社会之下被默许—所以保障的不仅是权力还有义务

a. John Rawls's First Principle of Justice

Each person may have a "fully adequate" number of rights and liberties as long as they are consistent with everyone else having the same rights and liberties.

- Right to life
- Right to property
- Right to privacy
- Liberty

b. John Rawls's second Principle of Justice

Any social and economic inequalities must satisfy two conditions:

- Everyone has a fair and equal opportunity to achieve their position in society
- Result in greatest benefit for the least-advantaged members of society (the Difference Principle)

Ans:

- ① 概念—In social contract theory, all rational beings or agents must share the same rights and liberties. /When there are inequalities, the principle of difference must hold.
- ② 找到 Rational beings
- ③ 分析每个人拥有什么样的权利/义务
- ④ 谁 violated 什么right—对谁unfair

⑤Therefore, the action is wrong/right.

▼ Sample Ans

Sample answer:

In social contract theory, all rational beings or agents must share the same rights and liberties. When there are inequalities, the principle of difference must hold.

1. Identify the **rational beings** or agents that are involved:

Alexis, the other library user, the college library

2. Evaluate their **rights** and responsibilities:

- Alexis, being not that college student, is not authorized to use the library facilities of another college. But she has the right to access the library of her own college.
- The private college has property rights of the computers and they are only accessible by the authorized users (students).
- Library users have their right of privacy to their account and the rights to use the college library resources.

3. Reflect on justice:

Alexis **violated the property rights** of the private college when she used the computer without permission. She **violated the privacy** of another person by stealing the account information. This is **unfair** to the other user.

Therefore, Alexis' action is wrong.

8. Virtue Ethics

A right action is an action that a virtuous person, acting in character, would do in the same circumstances.

- The virtues are those character traits human beings need in order to flourish and be truly happy.
 - Universal: honesty, justice, loyalty, etc.
 - Culture depend: (Western) self-reliance, (Chinese) self-regulation

Ans:

①概念– Virtue ethics focuses on the character of the individual and the cultivation of virtues such as honesty, justice, courage, and temperance.

②分析–自圆其说

▼ Sample Ans

1.5 Evaluate this scenario from the perspective of virtue ethics.

Virtue ethics focuses on the character of the individual and the cultivation of virtues such as honesty, justice, courage, and temperance.

In this scenario, it is clear that Alexis' actions are dishonest when she secretly obtains another person's login password. She has taken advantage of the college library's resources without asking permission, and taking advantage is clearly unjust behavior. She was not in control of her desires. This inappropriate behavior is a lack of moderation and self-control.

